

8.2.1 VCDs

VCD, or Video Compact Disc, as the name suggests, is a format that allows you to store video recordings on compact discs. The major restriction VCDs face is that they are limited to 650 or 700 MB of space. This means you can store, as with audio CDs, only about 74 (or 80) minutes of video on VCDs. VCD video is stored at a video bitrate of 1150 Kbps. VCDs are also fast losing popularity, as DVDs are a far more viable format these days. But VCD media are cheaper, and are good enough if you have about a hour or so of video.

8.2.1.1 VCD Requirements

Once you have your fully-edited home video on your computer, and you want to put it on a VCD and send it around, there are a few things you need before you get started.

- **Blank CD-R/RW:** Obviously. These days, almost all blank CDs are of 700 MB capacity. Depending on how long your video is, you'll need more or fewer of these.
- **File Splitter:** If your video is over 74/80 minutes, it's not going to fit on a single VCD. So you're going to have to split it into parts in order to burn it on to VCDs. These third-party software (file splitters) can split up a large movie into smaller parts.
- **VCD Converter Package:** These software packages can convert your home video from whatever format (WMV, AVI, etc.) they are stored on your computer to VCD-compliant format (MPEG-1), which can be read by any VCD player. They will also convert your video to an acceptable bitrate when converting.
- **CD-R/RW Drive and VCD burning software:** To burn the VCDs. Simple, no?

8.2.1.2 Splitting the Video

Trimming a film movie strip is as simple as taking a pair of scissors and cutting it where you want to split the movie. On the other hand, trimming a digital video involves recreating the entire trimmed bit frame by frame into a new media file. So observably,